

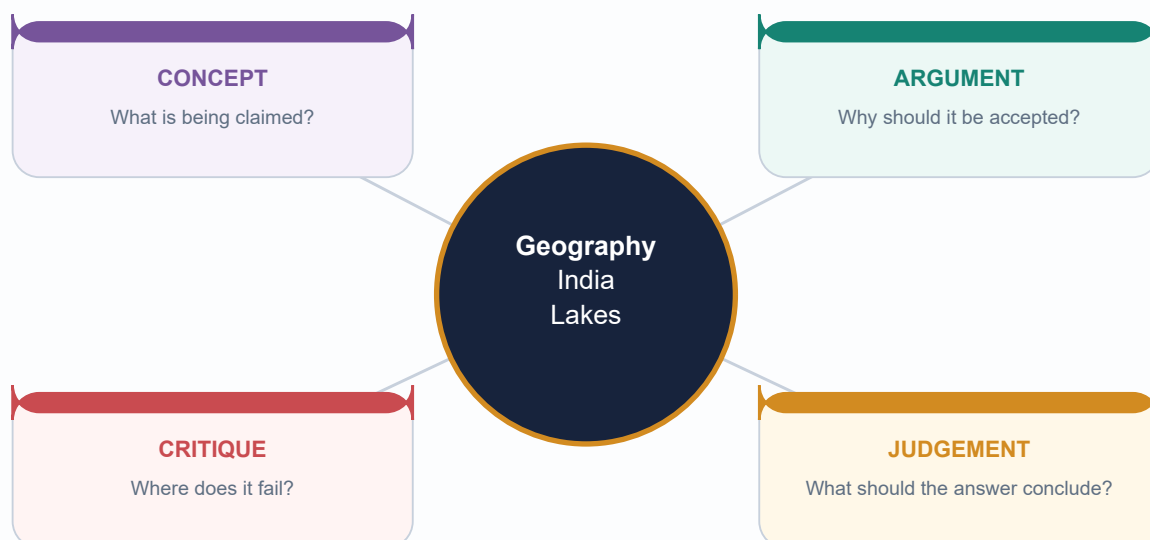
UPSC SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Geography 09 - India Lakes and Wetlands: Premium Solved Workbook

Geography | GS-I + GS-III | Prelims and Mains

10 objective PYQs + 3 Mains PYQs + 24 hard MCQs + 8 remedial MCQs + 3 original Mains

Original keys rotate A -> B -> C -> D; fixed PYQ options remain unchanged



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Solved workbook instructions and verification boundary

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

This workbook separates fixed-option UPSC PYQs from original questions. Fixed PYQ option order is preserved; only original hard/remedial MCQs are subjected to continuous A-B-C-D rotation.

STATIC THEORY

- Question wording was verified from local official UPSC scans.
- 2018-2023 objective answers are inferred because the official keys are not held locally.
- 2026 Q39 uses the local provisional Set-A key and remains explicitly not officially verified.
- Every Mains answer follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict and ends with Why this earns marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Attempt before reading the answer.
2. For statement questions, test each statement independently.
3. For map questions, attach region and process.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Using the answer label to skip elimination

CORRECT: Write a one-line elimination for each statement/option.

MAINS ANGLE

Target: accurate discrimination, not recall of isolated names.

STUDY LINK

Companion main package and reusable Markdown.

HIGH

VERIFIED PRELIMS PYQ 1 - 2018

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which of the following has/have shrunk immensely/dried up in the recent past due to human activities? 1. Aral Sea 2. Black Sea 3. Lake Baikal

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	1 only
B	2 and 3
C	2 only
D	1 and 3

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: A. Confidence: High.
- The Aral Sea shrank after large-scale diversion of its feeder rivers. The Black Sea has major pollution/eutrophication problems but did not dry up in this sense; Lake Baikal has not undergone comparable immense shrinkage.
- Source status: question wording verified from the local official UPSC scan. The answer status is stated separately and is not upgraded beyond the available key evidence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Fixed UPSC option order is preserved; PYQs are excluded from the original-question A-B-C-D rotation audit.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Treating an inferred answer as an official UPSC key

CORRECT: Retain the prominent inferred/provisional label until an official key is held locally.

MAINS ANGLE

Use the elimination chain, not memory of a coaching key.

STUDY LINK

Official local scan provenance is listed in the source register.

HIGH**VERIFIED PRELIMS PYQ 2 - 2018**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which one of the following is an artificial lake?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Kodaikanal (Tamil Nadu)
B	Kolleru (Andhra Pradesh)
C	Nainital (Uttarakhand)
D	Renuka (Himachal Pradesh)

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: A. Confidence: High.

- Kodaikanal Lake is human-made. Kolleru is a natural freshwater/floodplain lake; Nainital and Renuka are natural basins.

- Source status: question wording verified from the local official UPSC scan. The answer status is stated separately and is not upgraded beyond the available key evidence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Fixed UPSC option order is preserved; PYQs are excluded from the original-question A-B-C-D rotation audit.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Treating an inferred answer as an official UPSC key

CORRECT: Retain the prominent inferred/provisional label until an official key is held locally.

MAINS ANGLE

Use the elimination chain, not memory of a coaching key.

STUDY LINK

Official local scan provenance is listed in the source register.

HIGH

VERIFIED PRELIMS PYQ 3 - 2019

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Consider the following statements: 1. Under Ramsar Convention, it is mandatory for India to protect and conserve all wetlands in India. 2. Wetlands Rules 2010 were framed based on Ramsar recommendations. 3. Wetlands Rules 2010 encompass drainage/catchment regions as determined by the authority. Which is/are correct?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	1 and 2 only
B	2 and 3 only
C	3 only
D	1, 2 and 3

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: C. Confidence: High.

- Statement 1 overstates the treaty as a blanket mandatory protection rule for every wetland. Statement 2 is not the legal basis: the Rules were Indian rules under the Environment (Protection) Act. Statement 3 reflects the regulatory treatment of catchment/influence areas.

- Source status: question wording verified from the local official UPSC scan. The answer status is stated separately and is not upgraded beyond the available key evidence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Fixed UPSC option order is preserved; PYQs are excluded from the original-question A-B-C-D rotation audit.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Treating an inferred answer as an official UPSC key

CORRECT: Retain the prominent inferred/provisional label until an official key is held locally.

MAINS ANGLE

Use the elimination chain, not memory of a coaching key.

STUDY LINK

Official local scan provenance is listed in the source register.

HIGH

VERIFIED PRELIMS PYQ 4 - 2019

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

What is common to the places known as Aliyar, Isapur and Kangsabati?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Recently discovered uranium deposits
B	Tropical rain forests
C	Underground cave systems
D	Water reservoirs

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: D. Confidence: High.
- All three are reservoir/project names. The question tests artificial water bodies rather than natural lake genesis.
- Source status: question wording verified from the local official UPSC scan. The answer status is stated separately and is not upgraded beyond the available key evidence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Fixed UPSC option order is preserved; PYQs are excluded from the original-question A-B-C-D rotation audit.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Treating an inferred answer as an official UPSC key

CORRECT: Retain the prominent inferred/provisional label until an official key is held locally.

MAINS ANGLE

Use the elimination chain, not memory of a coaching key.

STUDY LINK

Official local scan provenance is listed in the source register.

HIGH**VERIFIED PRELIMS PYQ 5 - 2021**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

With reference to India, Didwana, Kuchaman, Sargol and Khatu are the names of

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Mangrove areas
B	Glaciers
C	Ramsar sites
D	Saline lakes

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: D. Confidence: High.
- They are Rajasthan saline-lake/playa names associated with arid closed-drainage settings.
- Source status: question wording verified from the local official UPSC scan. The answer status is stated separately and is not upgraded beyond the available key evidence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Fixed UPSC option order is preserved; PYQs are excluded from the original-question A-B-C-D rotation audit.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Treating an inferred answer as an official UPSC key

CORRECT: Retain the prominent inferred/provisional label until an official key is held locally.

MAINS ANGLE

Use the *elimination chain*, not memory of a coaching key.

STUDY LINK

Official local scan provenance is listed in the source register.

HIGH**VERIFIED PRELIMS PYQ 6 - 2022**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which one of the following lakes of West Africa has become dry and turned into a desert?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Lake Victoria
B	Lake Faguibine
C	Lake Oguta
D	Lake Volta

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: B. Confidence: High.

- Lake Faguibine in Mali is the intended answer; the others do not fit the described desiccation.

- Source status: question wording verified from the local official UPSC scan. The answer status is stated separately and is not upgraded beyond the available key evidence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Fixed UPSC option order is preserved; PYQs are excluded from the original-question A-B-C-D rotation audit.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Treating an inferred answer as an official UPSC key

CORRECT: Retain the prominent inferred/provisional label until an official key is held locally.

MAINS ANGLE

Use the *elimination chain*, not memory of a coaching key.

STUDY LINK

Official local scan provenance is listed in the source register.

HIGH

VERIFIED PRELIMS PYQ 7 - 2022

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Consider the pairs: 1. Hokera Wetland-Punjab 2. Renuka Wetland-Himachal Pradesh 3. Rudrasagar Lake-Tripura 4. Sasthamkotta Lake-Tamil Nadu. How many pairs are correctly matched?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Only one pair
B	Only two pairs
C	Only three pairs
D	All four pairs

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: B. Confidence: High.

- Renuka-Himachal Pradesh and Rudrasagar-Tripura are correct. Hokera is in Jammu and Kashmir; Sasthamkotta is in Kerala.

- Source status: question wording verified from the local official UPSC scan. The answer status is stated separately and is not upgraded beyond the available key evidence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Fixed UPSC option order is preserved; PYQs are excluded from the original-question A-B-C-D rotation audit.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Treating an inferred answer as an official UPSC key

CORRECT: Retain the prominent inferred/provisional label until an official key is held locally.

MAINS ANGLE

Use the elimination chain, not memory of a coaching key.

STUDY LINK

Official local scan provenance is listed in the source register.

HIGH

VERIFIED PRELIMS PYQ 8 - 2022

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

"If rainforests and tropical forests are the lungs of the Earth, then surely wetlands function as its kidneys." Which function best reflects this?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Water cycle involves runoff, percolation and evaporation
B	Algae form a nutrient base for food webs
C	Wetlands maintain sedimentation balance and soil stability
D	Aquatic plants absorb heavy metals and excess nutrients

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: D. Confidence: High.
- The kidney analogy points to filtration/retention and transformation of pollutants and excess nutrients.
- Source status: question wording verified from the local official UPSC scan. The answer status is stated separately and is not upgraded beyond the available key evidence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Fixed UPSC option order is preserved; PYQs are excluded from the original-question A-B-C-D rotation audit.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Treating an inferred answer as an official UPSC key

CORRECT: Retain the prominent inferred/provisional label until an official key is held locally.

MAINS ANGLE

Use the elimination chain, not memory of a coaching key.

STUDY LINK

Official local scan provenance is listed in the source register.

HIGH**VERIFIED PRELIMS PYQ 9 - 2023**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Consider the statements: 1. Jhelum River passes through Wular Lake. 2. Krishna River directly feeds Kolleru Lake. 3. Meandering of Gandak River formed Kanwar Lake. How many are correct?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Only one
B	Only two
C	All three
D	None

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: B. Confidence: High.
- Statements 1 and 3 are correct. Kolleru lies between the Krishna and Godavari delta systems but is not directly fed by the Krishna.
- Source status: question wording verified from the local official UPSC scan. The answer status is stated separately and is not upgraded beyond the available key evidence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Fixed UPSC option order is preserved; PYQs are excluded from the original-question A-B-C-D rotation audit.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Treating an inferred answer as an official UPSC key

CORRECT: Retain the prominent inferred/provisional label until an official key is held locally.

MAINS ANGLE

Use the elimination chain, not memory of a coaching key.

STUDY LINK

Official local scan provenance is listed in the source register.

HIGH**VERIFIED PRELIMS PYQ 10 - 2026**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

With reference to Lake Turkana: 1. It is the largest desert lake in the world. 2. It is in South Sudan along the eastern Sahara. 3. It is a UNESCO World Heritage Site and called the Jade Sea. Which is/are correct?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	1 only
B	1 and 3 only
C	2 and 3 only
D	1, 2 and 3

STATIC THEORY

- PROVISIONAL ANSWER KEY - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: B. Confidence: High.

- The local Set-A provisional key marks B. Lake Turkana lies mainly in Kenya with its northern end in Ethiopia, in the East African Rift rather than South Sudan/eastern Sahara; statements 1 and 3 are the intended correct pair.

- Source status: question wording verified from the local official UPSC scan. The answer status is stated separately and is not upgraded beyond the available key evidence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Fixed UPSC option order is preserved; PYQs are excluded from the original-question A-B-C-D rotation audit.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Treating an inferred answer as an official UPSC key

CORRECT: Retain the prominent inferred/provisional label until an official key is held locally.

MAINS ANGLE

Use the elimination chain, not memory of a coaching key.

STUDY LINK

Official local scan provenance is listed in the source register.

HIGH

VERIFIED MAINS PYQ 1 - 2018 GS-III

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

What is wetland? Explain the Ramsar concept of 'wise use' in the context of wetland conservation. Cite two examples of Ramsar sites from India. (150 words)

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Wetlands are hydro-ecological systems; wise use maintains ecological character through ecosystem approaches within sustainable development.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Chilika demonstrates salinity/inlet/fishery management; Loktak demonstrates phumdi-hydroperiod-livelihood interdependence.
- ANALYSIS: The principle allows compatible fisheries and community use while preventing activities that erode water regime, habitat and quality.
- QUALIFICATION: Ramsar designation is not automatic domestic protected-area status; the 2017 Rules and State authorities operationalise regulation.
- VERDICT: Wise use is therefore bounded use measured against ecological-character maintenance.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Why this earns marks: Definition, official concept, two Indian examples, governance qualification and direct conclusion fit a 10-mark answer.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Listing services or schemes without causal explanation

CORRECT: Make every named example prove a claim and answer the directive.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner-grade pattern: claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

STUDY LINK

GS-I / GS-III; keep the word limit and directive visible while writing.

HIGH

VERIFIED MAINS PYQ 2 - 2021 GS-I

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

What are the environmental implications of the reclamation of water bodies into urban land use? Explain with examples. (150 words)

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Reclamation removes hydrological storage and ecological function while locking exposure into the urban fabric.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Urban wetlands/lakes such as Dal and Bhoj, and flood-prone Indian cities with lost tanks/drains, show the combined pressure of sewage, sealing and encroachment.
- ANALYSIS: Runoff peaks rise, drainage paths narrow, groundwater interaction changes, habitat and evaporative cooling decline, and pollution is concentrated in the remaining water.
- QUALIFICATION: Wetlands have finite storage and are not universally recharge zones; protection must be paired with sewerage and catchment planning.
- VERDICT: Treat water bodies as blue-green infrastructure and regulate floodplain conversion before relying on larger drains.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Why this earns marks: The answer provides a causal chain, examples, qualification and a planning verdict rather than a generic service list.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Listing services or schemes without causal explanation

CORRECT: Make every named example prove a claim and answer the directive.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner-grade pattern: claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis
-> qualification -> verdict.

STUDY LINK

GS-I / GS-III; keep the word limit and directive visible while writing.

HIGH**VERIFIED MAINS PYQ 3 - 2023 GS-III**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Comment on the National Wetland Conservation Programme initiated by the Government of India and name a few India's wetlands of international importance included in the Ramsar Sites. (250 words)

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: NWCP created dedicated attention but must be updated to the present NPCA plus Wetlands Rules architecture.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: NWCP and NLCP merged into NPCA in 2013; Ramsar examples include Chilika, Loktak, Wular, Sambhar, Vembanad-Kol, Kolleru, Deepor Beel and Bhoj.
- ANALYSIS: NPCA funds integrated plans and restoration while the Rules create State authorities, notification and regulation; pollution and land use require further statutory convergence.
- QUALIFICATION: Growing designation and project counts do not prove ecological recovery; plans may be weakened by sewerage, encroachment, catchment and capacity gaps.
- VERDICT: Judge success through hydroperiod, connectivity, water quality, biota, livelihoods and governance trends.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Why this earns marks: It answers the historical programme, names sites, updates the institutional framework and gives a measured comment.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Listing services or schemes without causal explanation

CORRECT: Make every named example prove a claim and answer the directive.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner-grade pattern: claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis
-> qualification -> verdict.

STUDY LINK

GS-I / GS-III; keep the word limit and directive visible while writing.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 1**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Under the broad Ramsar definition, which can qualify as a wetland?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	A human-made temporary shallow water body
B	Only natural freshwater marshes
C	Only sites with 20,000 birds
D	Only protected areas

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. Ramsar deliberately includes artificial and temporary waters; designation criteria are a separate issue.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 2**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which factor most directly defines hydroperiod?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Catchment rock type alone
B	Timing, depth, duration and frequency of water presence
C	Ramsar status
D	Bird count alone

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. Hydroperiod is the temporal inundation/saturation regime.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH

ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 3

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which pairing is correct?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Lonar-volcanic
B	Pulicat-glacial
C	Kanwar-oxbow/floodplain
D	Wular-coastal lagoon

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. Kanwar/Kabar Tal is associated with river meandering and floodplain processes.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH

ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 4

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which statement is most accurate?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	All wetlands recharge groundwater
B	Only fens interact with groundwater
C	Reservoirs never seep
D	Wetlands may be recharge, discharge or alternating zones

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. Hydraulic gradients and seasons determine direction.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 5**
GS-I / GS-III
 Geography
NEWS TRIGGER

A long residence time commonly means

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Pollutants and nutrients may persist longer
B	Salinity cannot change
C	The lake must be exorheic
D	Turnover cannot occur

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. Lower flushing can prolong pollutant and nutrient retention.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 6**
GS-I / GS-III
 Geography
NEWS TRIGGER

In a stratified lake, the thermocline is

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	The shallow rooted-plant zone
B	The layer of rapid temperature change
C	The lake outlet
D	The sediment-water boundary

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. The metalimnion contains the rapid vertical temperature gradient.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 7**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which lake is correctly identified as artificial in the verified PYQ set?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Kolleru
B	Nainital
C	Kodaikanal
D	Renuka

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. Kodaikanal is the human-made option.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 8**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which sequence best describes cultural eutrophication?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Hypoxia -> nutrient removal -> bloom
B	Sediment removal -> nutrient load -> clear water
C	Turnover -> salt export -> eutrophy
D	Nutrient load -> production -> decay -> oxygen depletion

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. It states the full causal chain.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 9**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Internal loading refers to

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Release/recycling of nutrients from lake sediment
B	Only fertiliser use in fields
C	Tidal inflow into lagoons
D	Groundwater recharge

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. Sediments can release stored nutrients under chemical or physical disturbance.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH

ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 10

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which case is defined by phumdis?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Sambhar
B	Loktak
C	Bhoj
D	Pulicat

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. Phumdis are characteristic floating masses in Loktak.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH

ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 11

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

What did the Chilika restoration most clearly demonstrate?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Every lagoon needs a new mouth
B	Dredging alone restores wetlands
C	Hydrological intervention should follow modelling, monitoring and livelihood analysis
D	Ramsar designation bans fisheries

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. CDA used hydrodynamic diagnosis and monitoring; the lesson is method, not copying.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 12**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which category is explicitly excluded from the 2017 Rule definition?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Every natural marsh
B	Every Ramsar site
C	All coastal wetlands
D	Paddy fields

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. Paddy fields are an explicit exclusion in the notified definition.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 13**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

How many Ramsar criteria must a site satisfy at minimum?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	One
B	Two
C	Four
D	All nine

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. Meeting at least one criterion can support designation.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 14**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

The Montreux Record is best described as

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	A UNESCO heritage list
B	A priority record of listed sites with actual/likely ecological-character change
C	A list of artificial wetlands
D	A national funding scheme

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. It is a Ramsar accountability/attention mechanism.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 15**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Ramsar designation means

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Automatic National Park status
B	No human use
C	International recognition and wise-use/ecological-character obligations
D	Automatic NPCA funding

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. Domestic legal and funding actions remain separate.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 16**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which is a core State Wetland Authority function?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Issue Ramsar treaties
B	Operate every STP
C	Declare UNESCO sites
D	Inventory, recommend notification and review integrated plans

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. These functions are specified in the Rules.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 17**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

NPCA is primarily

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	A centrally sponsored conservation-management scheme
B	The legal text of the Ramsar Convention
C	A Supreme Court committee
D	A bird census

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. NPCA supports integrated management on a Centre-State/UT cost-sharing basis.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 18**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which restoration action should generally precede in-lake treatment?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Fish stocking
B	Stopping external pollutant load and protecting hydroperiod
C	Waterfront construction
D	Uniform dredging

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. Source control and process protection reduce recurrence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 19****GS-I / GS-III**

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which indicator set best captures ecological character?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Only Ramsar count
B	Only lake area
C	Hydrology, quality, sediment, biota, livelihoods and governance
D	Only bird tourism revenue

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. A multi-domain trend is required.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 20****GS-I / GS-III**

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which climate statement is safest?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Wetlands always cool every city
B	Every wetland is a net carbon sink annually
C	Wetlands prevent all floods
D	Wetlands can reduce risk but services have capacity and methane/recharge caveats

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. The qualified statement respects system and event limits.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 21**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which statement best separates natural and cultural eutrophication?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Cultural eutrophication is human-accelerated nutrient enrichment
B	Natural eutrophication is always toxic
C	Cultural eutrophication is basin formation
D	There is no difference

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. The distinction is rate and anthropogenic loading.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 22**
GS-I / GS-III
 Geography
NEWS TRIGGER

Why is 'all wetlands recharge groundwater' wrong?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Wetlands contain no water
B	Some wetlands receive groundwater discharge or alternate seasonally
C	Only coastal wetlands exist
D	Recharge is a Ramsar criterion

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. Direction follows hydraulic gradient.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 23**
GS-I / GS-III
 Geography
NEWS TRIGGER

Which is the best response to sediment infilling?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Dredge every year
B	Ignore the catchment
C	Reduce catchment erosion and diagnose bathymetry/contaminants before selective removal
D	Convert the shoreline

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. Source control and risk assessment precede removal.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**ORIGINAL HARD MCQ 24**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which current statement is correct as of 2026-08-16?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	India had 99 Ramsar Sites
B	Surha Tal was the 101st
C	Glaw Lake was in Uttar Pradesh
D	Glaw Lake made the tally 101 on 3 August 2026

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. PIB 2294036 records Glaw as Arunachal Pradesh's first and India's 101st site.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**REMEDIAL MCQ 1**
GS-I / GS-III
 Geography
NEWS TRIGGER

Which is a geomorphic rather than legal statement?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Chilika is a barrier lagoon
B	Chilika is automatically a National Park
C	Every lagoon is Ramsar-listed
D	Ramsar sites prohibit fisheries

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. Barrier-lagoon classification is physical geography; the other claims misuse designation.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**REMEDIAL MCQ 2**
GS-I / GS-III
 Geography
NEWS TRIGGER

Which blanket service claim should be rejected?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Wetlands can retain sediment
B	Every wetland recharges groundwater
C	Floodplains can store water
D	Marshes can support fisheries

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. Recharge/discharge depends on hydraulic setting.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**REMEDIAL MCQ 3**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

A city removes weeds yearly but sewage inflow continues. The strongest diagnosis is

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Successful restoration
B	Natural ageing only
C	Symptom treatment without external-load control
D	A tectonic problem

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. Weed removal cannot overcome continuing nutrient and organic loading.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**REMEDIAL MCQ 4**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which pair is mismatched?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Wular-Jhelum
B	Loktak-phumdis
C	Lonar-impact crater
D	Pulicat-west coast

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. Pulicat is an east-coast lagoon.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**REMEDIAL MCQ 5**GS-I / GS-III
Geography**NEWS TRIGGER**

Which statement on flood buffering is correct?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Benefit depends on available storage, connection and event magnitude
B	A saturated wetland has unlimited capacity
C	Any wetland eliminates urban floods
D	Flood control is unrelated to land use

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. Flood moderation is conditional.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**REMEDIAL MCQ 6**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which governance distinction is correct?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Ramsar listing is NPCA funding
B	Wetlands Rules regulate; NPCA supports conservation projects
C	Amrit Dharohar is the Ramsar treaty
D	CPCB designates Ramsar sites

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. Rule and scheme functions differ.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**REMEDIAL MCQ 7**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Which indicator most directly tests lagoon connectivity?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	National bird count only
B	Tourist arrivals
C	Sea-mouth/inlet condition and salinity gradient
D	Designation year

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. Lagoon ecological character depends on exchange and resulting salinity.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH**REMEDIAL MCQ 8**GS-I / GS-III
Geography**NEWS TRIGGER**

Which status label is correct for the local 2026 Lake Turkana answer?

KEY DATA

Option	Text
A	Officially verified
B	No answer available
C	Inferred without any key
D	Provisional answer key - not officially verified

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. The repository holds a provisional Set-A key, not an official final key.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every option was checked independently; the key sequence is validated separately.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choosing by a familiar site name alone

CORRECT: Test the process, legal status and hydrological qualifier in the stem.

MAINS ANGLE

Prelims method: eliminate blanket words, separate physical geography from designation status, then test the remaining pair.

STUDY LINK

Revision route: definition -> process -> Indian example -> governance.

HIGH

ORIGINAL SOLVED MAINS 1 - 10 marks

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Distinguish lake origin, trophic state and Ramsar status. Why is this distinction important? (150 words)

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Origin, trophic state and Ramsar status answer different questions and should never be used as substitutes.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Lonar is impact-origin and saline-alkaline; Chilika is lagoon-origin and Ramsar-listed; Bhoj is artificial-origin and Ramsar-listed; a lake can become eutrophic regardless of origin.
- ANALYSIS: Origin explains basin genesis, trophic state nutrient/productivity condition, and Ramsar international importance/governance obligation.
- QUALIFICATION: Each can change or remain independent: designation does not fix eutrophy, and artificial origin does not preclude ecological value.
- VERDICT: UPSC answers should classify on all relevant axes before recommending management.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Why this earns marks: It defines three axes, uses named contrasting cases, explains analytical value and rejects category errors.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Listing services or schemes without causal explanation

CORRECT: Make every named example prove a claim and answer the directive.

MAINS ANGLE

*Examiner-grade pattern: claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis
-> qualification -> verdict.*

STUDY LINK

GS-I / GS-III; keep the word limit and directive visible while writing.

HIGH

ORIGINAL SOLVED MAINS 2 - 15 marks

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Compare the degradation pathways of Sambhar, Loktak and Chilika. (250 words)

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: The three wetlands show that similar symptoms such as biodiversity or fishery decline can arise from different hydrological failures.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Sambhar is a closed saline basin sensitive to inflow, evaporation and salt extraction; Loktak's phumdis depend on seasonal level dynamics altered by barrage operation plus catchment pressures; Chilika's brackish ecology depends on river-tide-sea-mouth exchange.
- ANALYSIS: Therefore Sambhar requires basin water/salinity governance, Loktak hydroperiod and livelihood co-management, and Chilika adaptive inlet/salinity management.
- QUALIFICATION: All three also face pollution and sediment, and Chilika's intervention cannot be copied without local hydrodynamic evidence.
- VERDICT: Diagnosis should precede restoration, with a shared monitoring frame but different priority levers.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Why this earns marks: It compares mechanisms rather than listing threats, gives one tailored lever per case and includes a transferability warning.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Listing services or schemes without causal explanation

CORRECT: Make every named example prove a claim and answer the directive.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner-grade pattern: claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

STUDY LINK

GS-I / GS-III; keep the word limit and directive visible while writing.

HIGH**ORIGINAL SOLVED MAINS 3 - 20 marks**

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evaluate India's wetland governance and propose a measurable reform agenda. (300 words)

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: India has built a layered architecture, but implementation quality and ecological-character reporting remain the decisive tests.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: The Ramsar network reached 101 on 3 August 2026; the 2017 Rules create State/UT Authorities; NPCA funds integrated management; Amrit Dharohar adds community, livelihood/nature-tourism and carbon objectives.
- ANALYSIS: This architecture can combine recognition, regulation, finance and participation, yet notification gaps, fragmented urban/catchment agencies, untreated sewage, encroachment and project-centred reporting weaken outcomes.
- QUALIFICATION: The Montreux status of Loktak/Keoladeo and Chilika's recovery show that both deterioration and correction are possible; count alone is therefore neither meaningless nor sufficient.
- VERDICT: Reforms: complete digital inventories/demarcation; publish integrated plans and budgets; basin-scale inflow/quality targets; strengthen SPCB-ULB convergence; livelihood co-management; annual dashboards for extent, hydroperiod, DO/nutrients/salinity, sediment, native/invasive biota and compliance.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Why this earns marks: Success should be defined as maintained or improving ecological character with equitable wise use, not merely more designations or works completed. The answer covers achievements and gaps, uses current and historical evidence, qualifies the count debate and ends with measurable institutional reforms.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Listing services or schemes without causal explanation

CORRECT: Make every named example prove a claim and answer the directive.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner-grade pattern: claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

STUDY LINK

GS-I / GS-III; keep the word limit and directive visible while writing.